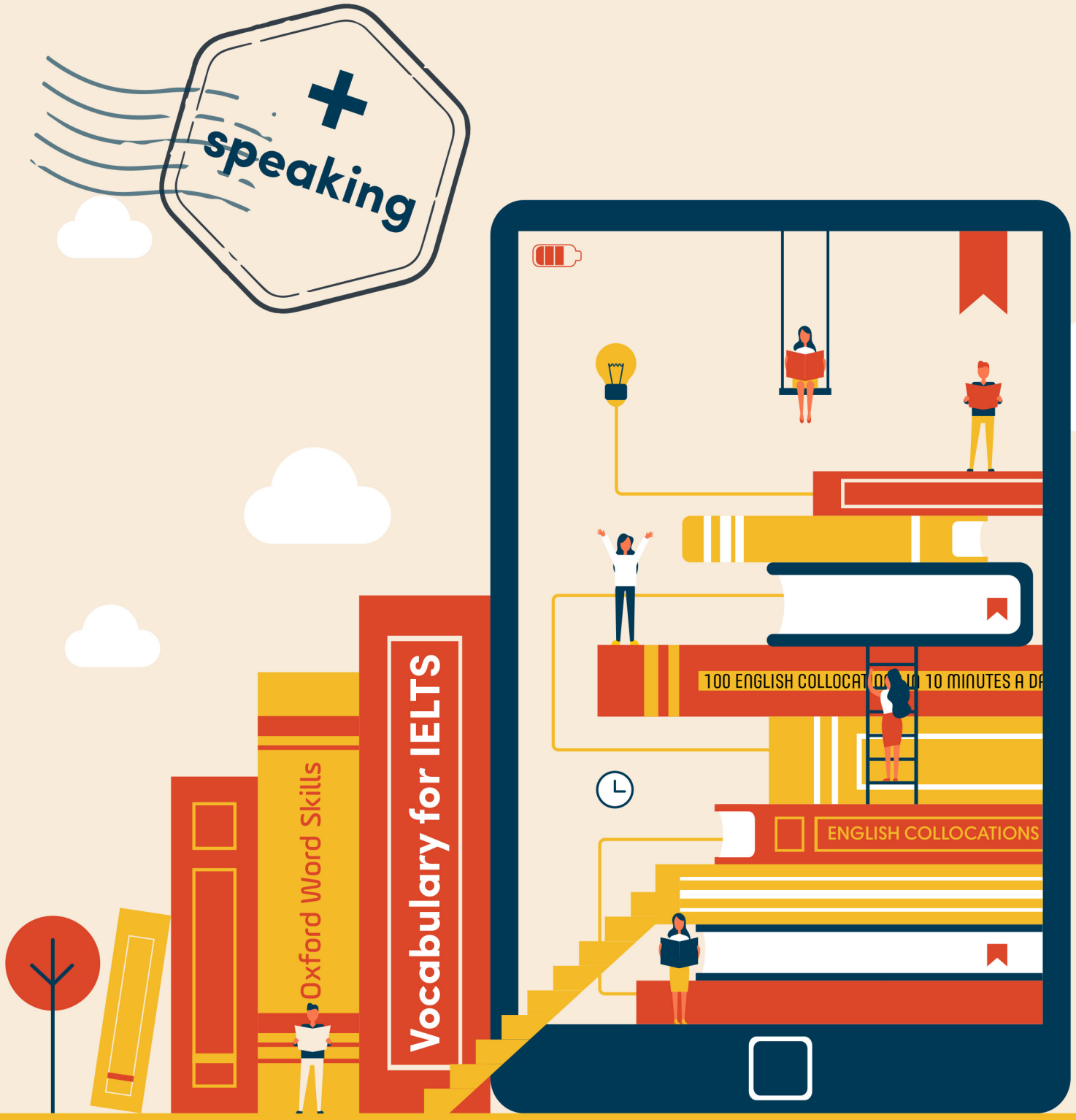
IELTS Up Words!

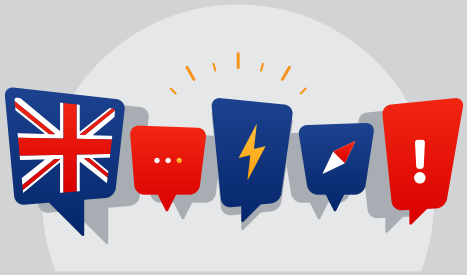
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IELTS Up Words!

Lesson 66: Hometown

Hello there! You are listening to lesson sixty-six of IELTS Up Words! What do you say we talk about your hometown in this lesson, huh? It might bring back fond memories of your childhood or hit you with a wave of nostalgia.

Where did you grow up? Some people grew up as urbanites in the cities, while some as villagers in the tranquil countryside surrounded by breathtaking scenery. No matter where your roots are or where you were born and raised, you should be prepared to talk about it at length because it is a common IETLS speaking question.

Now, let's get started with a part-two IELTS question. Grab a pen and paper to take notes. Ready?

Describe your hometown. You should say:

- where it is located
- what it is known for
- what the main industries in your hometown are
- what languages are spoken there
- what the advantages and disadvantages of living there are

My hometown is Tehran, the capital city of Iran. It is situated in north-central of Iran, at the foot of the Alborz mountain range. The main language is Persian, but it is not uncommon to hear people speak in a dialect spoken in other regions of the country, which is because a lot of people from the countryside or other cities and towns move to Tehran in the hope of gaining a better standard of living.

Tehran is the main economic center of Iran, and its present-day modern industries include the manufacturing of automobiles, and two of its most famous auto companies

are Saipa and Iran Khodro. It is also a hotspot for start-ups and tech innovation with all the Internet cafés and shared workplaces opening every day. Compared to many other countries, it is far easier to start an online business here or launch a product, and it seems like Tehraners know it very well.

And as for the advantages of living in Tehran, I think the biggest one is its café culture. Tiny pavement cafés seem to be found on every street corner, and sometimes you will even find several in a row. Each coffee shop has its own type of patrons and ambiance and food that you can choose from. Another benefit of Tehran is its decent public transport system. You have many options ranging from buses, trains, and car-hailing apps.

On the other hand, one of the main downsides of this city is the sense of isolation many people can feel here. Because of the volume of traffic, it is hard to go to places around the city, and therefore, a lot of us prefer to stay home to avoid bumper-to-bumper traffic. This has contributed to the loneliness that I mentioned. Another disadvantage of living in Tehran is the fact that there are many no-go areas, where a lot of homeless addicts gather at night. So, it is not safe to pass through these deprived areas after dark.

Speaking Tip



More Part Two Tips

Break down your response into smaller, more manageable segments.

Find the simpler parts of the cue card that do not require giving too much information and talk about them first.

Take notes of at least three points about the other parts of the question. Ideally, they should include support and example.

Your talk does not need to run in the order of the question parts.

Start your talk with something like “I am going to talk about...” or “I would like to talk about...”

Continue your talk and answer each new section of the cue card either directly or indirectly.

Answering directly means you go straight to the answer.

Answering indirectly means you start with an introduction for your response. Example: “With regards to the main industries of my city, I would say that it is mostly...” or “As for the main industries of my city, I would say that...”

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
it brought back fond memories of my childhood	I was reminded of happy memories from my childhood	خاطرات خوشی از کودکی‌ام را به‌یادم آورد	to reminisce
hit you with a wave of nostalgia	being filled with a sudden strong feeling of nostalgia	گرفتن یک حس عمیق نوستالژی	nostalgic
urbanites	people who live in cities or towns	شهرنشین‌ها	related: urban sprawl; concrete jungle
villagers	people who live in villages	روستانشین‌ها	
the tranquil countryside	the peaceful and quiet rural area	حومهٔ شهر آرام و بی‌دغدغه	Serene unspoiled/ peaceful countryside
breathtaking scenery	extremely beautiful landscapes	مناظر خیره‌کننده	spectacular vide
where your roots are	where your family origins are and the particular place that you come from	ریشه‌ات کجا است	
manufacturing of automobiles	the industrial products of cars and motor vehicles using machinery	ساخت و تولید اتومبیل	automotive; automotive industry
it is situated in north-central of Iran	it is in the central part of Iran's northern region	در شمال مرکزی ایران واقع شده	it is located in north-central of Iran

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
dialect	a form of a language that people speak in a particular part of a country, containing some different words and grammar	گویش	compare with jargon and lingo
a hotspot for start-ups	a very popular or active place for start-ups to establish their business	نقطه‌ای محبوب برای استارت‌آپ‌ها (و شروع فعالیتشان)	
café culture	a lifestyle characterized by regular social visits to cafés or coffeehouses	فرهنگ کافه‌نشینی	coffee culture
pavement cafés	cafés that have tables and chairs outside near the street	کافه‌هایی که میزها و صندلی‌هایی در پیاده‌رو و نزدیک خیابان دارند؛ کافه‌های لب‌خیابان	sidewalk café
the sense of isolation	the feeling of being separated from other people, or a situation in which you do not have the support of other people	حس انزوا	to isolate; social isolation
the volume of traffic	the amount of traffic and cars moving along the road	حجم ترافیک	traffic jam; congestion
bumper-to-bumper traffic	a long line of vehicles that are so close together and moving very slowly	ترافیک سپربه‌سپر؛ ترافیک سنگینی که در آن ماشین‌ها بسیار نزدیک به هم هستند و به‌کندی حرکت می‌کنند	
no-go areas	forbidden zones	مناطق ممنوعه	compare with red-light district
deprived areas	areas lacking something that is needed to live the way most people live	مناطق محروم	Deprivation sleep-deprived

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to launch a product	to introduce a new product for sale for the first time and attract people's attention to it	معرفی محصول جدیدی به بازار	to unveil a product
patrons	a customer, especially a regular one, of a store, restaurant, or theater	مشتری‌های همیشگی	compared with customer A customer is someone who buys a product or a service. A patron is a loyal customer.
ambiance	the character and atmosphere of a place	حال‌وهوا؛ محیط	compared with atmosphere ambiance = the vibes or general feeling that an environment gives off; a theme atmosphere = the certain mood or disposition that a place creates or implies related: a more relaxed atmosphere
car-hailing apps	smartphone apps that let you book rides and pay for car service	اپ‌های درخواست ماشین (تاکسی)	to hail a cab ride-hailing; ride-sharing
ideally	used when describing the perfect situation	به‌طور ایده‌آل؛ در بهترین حالت	preferably; in an ideal world



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